Know the GAP!
WTI for Gender Equality

world trade institute

UNIVERSITÄT BERN

THE HIDDEN COSTS OF CRISES: GENDER, INEQUALITY, AND RECOVERY

29 September 2026
12:30–13:30 CEST
HYBRID EVENT*

Simonetta Zarrilli
ARTNeT

* This event will take place in person at the Anna Nussbaum Auditorium, World Trade Institute, Hallerstrasse 6, 3012 Bern, Switzerland, and online via Zoom. To join remotely, please use this **LINK**

ABSTRACT

Trade is often portrayed as a pathway to growth, resilience, and recovery from crises. But are economic crises – and the policies designed to address them – experienced in the same way by everyone? From geopolitical tensions and supply chain disruptions to food, energy, and financial shocks, the consequences of crises are shaped by unequal access to resources, labour market segmentation, and unpaid care responsibilities. By examining who bears the costs of crises and who benefits from recovery, this lecture invites participants to rethink some of the assumptions underlying trade policy and to explore what they may be overlooking.

BIOGRAPHY OF THE SPEAKER



Simonetta Zarrilli is a leading trade analyst with over 30 years of experience in the United Nations system. Her work has focused on policy analysis, capacity-building, and international dialogue on trade and development.
Simonetta is currently an advisor to the Asia-Pacific Research and Training Network on Trade, ARTNeT, and a founding member of the WTO Gender Research Hub. In 2010, she launched UNCTAD's Trade, Gender and Development Programme, which she directed until her retirement from the organization in 2024. Over the course of her career, she has addressed a wide range of issues – from renewable energy and biotechnology to health and environmental services, and preferential tariff schemes – and has published extensively on these topics.
In recognition of her groundbreaking work linking trade and gender equality, Simonetta received the WTO's inaugural Gender Equality Pioneering Award in 2023.
She holds a law degree with highest honours from the University of Siena in Italy and a postgraduate degree in European Studies from the College of Europe in Bruges.

The Gender Lecture Series is organized by the Gender Team of the World Trade Institute – Know the GAP!, led by Prof. Elisa Fornalé, in collaboration with the Faculty of Law of the University of Bern

THIS EVENT IS ORGANIZED AS PART OF THE GENDER LECTURE SERIES 2026-2027

GENDER LECTURE SERIES 2026-2027

GENDERED PRECARITIES

This event will take place in person at the Anna Nussbaum Auditorium, World Trade Institute, Hallerstrasse 6, 3012 Bern, Switzerland, and online via Zoom.
To join remotely, please use this **LINK**.

For further information please email Dr Simone Ferrari: simone.ferrari@unibe.ch